

India's Wide-Body Window

Where should Indian carriers deploy their next 100 long-haul aircraft, and can the India-Gulf corridor absorb them?

THE ANSWER

Compete with the Gulf hubs. Do not fly more aircraft to them. Europe first, North America second.

78.0M

India international sector passengers, 2025, computed from DGCA

8.5M

of them are connecting onward through a Gulf hub, not going to the Gulf

78%

the firm wide-body order book would add to Indian carriers' international capacity

Why the aircraft should not go to the Gulf, though the traffic is there

1. **Almost no room.** India-Dubai runs at 88.8% of its reported bilateral entitlement. Abu Dhabi is looser at 70.1%, so the corridor is not uniformly capped, but the two together leave space for about 4% of the order book.
2. **The worst unit economics on the map.** Scaling IndiGo's published unit cost across corridors, Gulf sectors have the least room of any to absorb a yield decline, and do not cover their own cost at IndiGo's realised yield. Europe can take about a fifth off the fare and still clear.
3. **An order book sized for a longer network.** It clears only if the average sector lengthens about 27%, or if Indian carriers take 58% of the market.

The corridor stays the prize: of 39.7M Gulf passengers, roughly 8.5M are travelling onward to Europe and North America on a Gulf carrier, a contested pool worth **INR 28,900 to 56,700 crore**. That traffic is won by flying past the Gulf, not to it.

Why the numbers can be checked rather than taken on trust

Every figure is computed in-repo from DGCA, Eurostat and World Bank data, or gated against a primary filing: a status gate refuses any hand-entered number that has not been verified, and it has blocked real work rather than been relaxed. DGCA and Eurostat, measuring the same routes from opposite ends, agree to 2.6%. Six changes of mind are published with the commit each happened in, including a claim that was on the page and had to be withdrawn.

india-widebody-window.vercel.app

What building this demonstrates

A self-directed case in the style of BCN Advanced Manufacturing & Services commercial aviation work. Python analysis layer, static site, no PowerPoint and no Excel anywhere in the pipeline.

FROM THE POSTING	WHERE IT IS EVIDENCED
Go-to-market strategy	A named client, five costed options each with what would have to be true, a phased roadmap and a nine-row risk register
Industry analysis and competitive benchmarking	India's international market by corridor, carrier and stage length; Indian carriers against Gulf carriers on share, load factor and sector length
Model building	Capacity absorption in ASK, corridor breakeven, market sizing to a band across three methods, and a sensitivity on every modelled knob. Reimagined in Python; the repo forbids Excel as output or intermediate
Secondary research	Every field sourced, dated and reliability graded in a data dictionary; conflicts flagged rather than resolved to whichever was convenient
Judgement where data is thin	An assumption gate, a disputed route quarantined, an unverifiable origin-destination share bounded rather than asserted
Storylining	SCQA, answer-first structure, and action titles on every chart enforced by a test

What it does not evidence, stated rather than stretched

A script maps the real posting to artifacts and checks each exists. It reports **82%**, not 100%. Three requirements cannot be honestly evidenced by one person working alone, and are listed rather than papered over: survey analysis, mentoring analysts, and first-level team management. A fielded-ready conjoint instrument for the softest number in the case is designed and included, and survey analysis is *still* counted as a gap, because designing a survey is not analysing one.

The part I would most want to be asked about

A bug once misfiled 5.0M passengers a year, a fifth of the entire Gulf flow, into the wrong bucket. All 72 tests passed throughout, because a wrong bucket is still a valid bucket. It was found by chasing an unrelated number. Four of the six documented corrections came from cross-checking one source against another; none came from the test suite. That is why the reconciliation work is an exhibit on the site rather than an appendix.

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